

Suddenly I was feeling exceedingly confident but greatly overwhelmed at the thought of whom it was, precisely. I was now corresponding with. As promised a short four days later, on September 5, 1997 the response to my initial letter arrived, handprinted on yellow lined paper, certainly original and no copy of anything. I was forearmed with the knowledge that Philip J. Corso had been given responsibility to oversee the Army's Foreign Technology Desk of their Research And Development Section, basically checking out the competition's weaponry, defense systems, etc. whether it be friend or foe. This was from 1961-1963, and his longtime mentor and superior, Lieut. General Arthur Trudeau, informed Corso of additional responsibility for the aforementioned Roswell materials.

Some of Corso's previous duties had included service as a National Security Advisor to President Eisenhower; he'd also served under General Douglas MacArthur in several capacities, and later had represented Senators Richard Russell and James O. Eastland on the Warren Commission investigating the assassination of President John F. Kennedy. Senator Strom Thurmond had hired Corso as a staff aide upon the Colonel's retirement from the military but controversy ensued following the release of "the Day After Roswell" years later. A glowing Foreword to the book written by Thurmond was later disclaimed by the Senator since he, as the story goes, had written it for a book that was to be titled "I Walked With Giants" chronicling Corso's many noble military experiences and the high level people the Colonel worked with; instead the book primarily covered the Colonel's claimed "secret" duty of involvement with UFOs. I of course asked Col. Corso about this, and he'd written that the "fuss" had been started by a member of Thurmond's current staff rather than Thurmond himself; Corso further stated he and the Senator were still on very good terms and the staff member had since been fired.

With guarded feelings I decided to see if lightning would strike twice so to speak. I sent the Colonel a second letter including my first two Roswell papers and an advertisement for one of my previous presentations. I also respectfully requested that the Colonel read and critique the papers, given his potentially immense position of inside information on Roswell and who knows what else?

I dispatched this package on a Saturday by USPS Express Mail, then waited. Two mornings later he called me at my place of business, and after I expressed my appreciation for his call, here's what I heard: "I read both your papers and I liked them but there are things you don't know about, so when you're ready for your third paper (as I'd indicated prior intent) *call me and I'll fill you in. Here's my number.....*".

As if this dream isn't long enough already, mine's coming in "chapters."

Around this time, my MUFON friend Diane Stavaris faxed me an advertisement for an upcoming lecture at Rutgers University- New Brunswick Campus, given by the internationally honored environmentalist, reporter and researcher Linda Moulton Howe. I had respected her very highly since seeing her Emmy Award winning documentary film "A Strange Harvest", concerning the animal mutilation phenomenon (primarily but not restricted to cattle) that had exploded worldwide in the mid 1960s and beyond. I possessed my own video copy courtesy of another fellow government employee John Leo. He had offered me his taped copy in consideration of my paranormal interests, and I accepted it gratefully.

Since portions of her lecture were advertised as Roswell related, I thought Ms. Howe might like to have a copy of my letter from Col. Corso; I sent it to her lecture sponsor along with my papers and the initial letter prompting the Colonel's response. As it turned out, Linda and Col. Corso had met and become friends while in Roswell during the 50th Anniversary festivities along with other dignitaries. Linda obtained a sizeable audiotape interview with the Colonel while they were in New Mexico; nevertheless, Frontier Research Seminars President and Physicist Art Wagner told me Linda was "interested" in what I'd sent her.

A few days later Art invited me and anyone of my choosing to a private dinner party in Linda's honor on the night prior to the Rutgers lecture. My in law Rhea Cobb and Diane Stavaris accompanied me to the party numbering about eleven people. One woman was an author/contactee, another woman claimed to be an abductee. Linda's conversations with the former were stunning and quite mesmerizing to the rest of us; on our return trip from the Somerset NJ restaurant Diane, Rhea and I actually felt as if some brand new world had just made its presence known to us, as astonished as we were. I also had the honor of sitting next to Linda despite our group being thirty minutes late to the party. (Straight from the "Open Mouth, Insert Foot" Department; I thought I'd cleverly made light of my embarrassment at being late by joking "sorry, we were abducted" to a group I later learned included two "experiencers"....certainly an auspicious debut on my part.)

The lecture one day hence was quite provocative and informative, and our small North Jersey contingent was joined by my sister Joy and colleague Len Pretko for the Rutgers event. A brief portion of the lecture was later televised on the NJ-Channel 12 News.

Linda Moulton Howe and I soon became friends in part due to a shared goal, that being further personal contact with Colonel Corso. For Linda any future meeting with the Colonel would be renewing a previous and valued friendship. For me it would be nothing short of a remarkable "first" just to even thank him for opening up to me. More than that, however, Linda and I speculated on the possibility of seeing him together, but could we pull it off? Due to a Corso family problem that towards the end of 1997 was making interaction between the Colonel and any "outsiders" extremely difficult, we decided to hatch a little conspiracy of sorts. I phoned Col. Corso and said I'll be vacationing in his home area in early December, and could I possibly stop in just to shake his hand, thank him, and perhaps chat a while? Col. Corso was most engaging to the idea, so he agreed and we then worked out a tentative meeting date and schedule without prior knowledge that his friend Linda Howe would be visiting as well.

Our little plan worked to perfection. Prepared for some contingencies, I met this unique man at a restaurant near his residence, and moments later Linda followed me in. Watching these two wonderful people reunite was exhilarating, knowing full well I'd contributed. Feeling somewhat miniscule and gigantic at the same time, I forgot all thoughts of my Newark Airport departure having left ninety minutes late, upsetting the timing of our intentions. No matter, we were all here, and I was feeling "higher" than any Mogul balloon had ever reached!

My specific preparation for the meeting had been an expeditious re-reading of "The Day After Roswell": the listing of a series of questions both of my own and also supplied by researcher Robert Coniglio (a Connecticut gentleman I'd met at the Friedman lecture six months earlier) and an uncompleted reading of UFO debunker Philip Klass' new work "the Real Roswell Crashed Saucer

Cover-Up". (The latter, an acknowledged "skeptic's" work would, I surmised, provide balance to my UFO research, or so I thought.)

We began at 8:45 AM on Thursday December 4, 1997. No photos were taken nor were any recording devices used, at least none we knew of.

Colonel Corso's very first comment concerned the Philip Klass book he'd spotted in my briefcase amongst other materials. "Klass..." he muttered dismissively, making Linda and I immediately take notice. Do you know him, we asked, to which the Colonel responded, "That guy can attack me in the media, newspapers, TV, any way he wants to....but he'll never attack me face to face". Why, we asked? "Because", the Colonel continued, "*he knows that I know he was in the CIA for a time*". I for one was startled at this statement. I and Linda and many of the world's UFO enthusiasts would likely have suspected such an allegiance all the while despite Klass' long repeated denials of same; yet if Corso's accusation were true it would provide an entirely different purpose to Klass' career attempts at "alternative explanations" (read it to mean complete discrediting) of alleged UFO encounters.

(Weeks later in a phone conversation I reiterated to the Colonel my concerns regarding the accuracy of the CIA-Klass "connection". Corso replied affirmatively-again-and added "look, back in those days it was part of my job to know such things". The phrase "back then" may have been a reference to Corso's post war duty in Italy. Even today he is still considered a national hero there for his work in greatly reducing the influence of the communists, ex-Nazis and organized crime in Rome; however I let the inference stand at face value. In any case, if Corso could substantiate the CIA claim, Klass' credibility would be at serious risk since he'd have lied about his personal background for decades. As such, correctly or not, he would be stamped an "agenda" debunker still determined at all costs to dismiss UFOs, but now in behalf of an Intelligence Agency of the U.S. Government. I'll definitely be pursuing this subject further in the future.)

Linda Howe brought with her the working manuscript for her third book "Glimpses Of Other Realities Vol. II: High Strangeness", since released. Howe was requesting legal clearance from Corso to use quotes of his in the book. Having finished Linda's "An Alien Harvest" and currently splitting time on her "Glimpses Of Other Realities Vol. I: Facts And Eyewitnesses" with the new Klass effort, I was most eager to discover what the new "Glimpses" would offer. The three of us were perusing the text, checking different maps, chapter headings and varied subjects and I reminded Linda that her new book was to include a computer simulated graphic of a real UFO, supplied her by a confidential military source.²⁷ When we checked out the graphic on page 33 Colonel Corso immediately placed a straightened finger on the page and blurted out "That's what I saw near Roswell!"²⁸ (Note: Corso later indicated his personal UFO encounter took place some ten or more years after the Roswell Incident while he was a Missile Battery Commander in the Red Canyon area of New Mexico.)

We made the Colonel aware of some concerns over real or perceived errors in his book. One area of discussion regarded his comments on the makeup of the Nike missile, and another was the lack of a bibliography or supportive documentation for his story. Corso looked at us and said "I've only read two UFO books in my life, one by Linda and one by (Dr.) Jacques Valle. Hell, I didn't need to read anything else", implying his working UFO knowledge was more than a sufficient substitute for conventional research. (Neither interviewer was about to dispute the implication.)

Corso also wanted us aware that the final manuscript for his book went into print before he ever had the chance to proofread it, one matter among several currently causing legal difficulties.

Linda suggested Colonel Corso's full story be videotaped for posterity, believing his spoken word would carry even greater weight than the written one. Corso noted not only had he not made "plenty" of money on his book as the debunkers were saying; he'd actually lost money, not having been paid anything for the book combined with current legal entanglements and the costs of same. I was not actively involved in this portion of the meeting, but I listened attentively and was promised the opportunity to attend the future videotaping session. Linda hoped that following the resolution of his present legal matters the Colonel could then pursue the proposal. As of May 1998, no such project had begun.

Colonel Corso surprised us by revealing he was working on a new manuscript for a second book, this one free of embellishments or a co-author, and he offered to send rough copies to both of us "to see what we thought of it." (I couldn't believe my ears, but I learned thereafter the Colonel meant exactly what he'd said.) I told him I'd be most honored and flattered to be included in such a consideration, but that Linda's experience as a professional journalist (and the author of three outstanding books on the paranormal) would be of far greater assistance to the Colonel; she, not I, should have the opportunity to review such a manuscript first.

While he appeared to appreciate my taking the "high ground" on the matter, The Colonel seemed unfazed and added that if he decided to make two copies he'd send one to each of us, or if lacking two copies perhaps Linda and I could share one. Additionally Col. Corso wondered aloud whether he should bother with the new manuscript or just "burn it." We countered by saying if he were telling the truth and had decided to speak out about it, he should follow it through whether it be with our help or someone else's; besides, we added, who else will disclose such matters if he doesn't? Including the personal letters , this was my second experience with the Colonel expressing sensitivity over his controversial revelations combined with uncertainty over whether the effort had been worth the trouble.

One of my correspondence questions to Corso had asked for his best estimate, based on his high contacts, of what exactly happened in New Mexico in July 1947. The Colonel responded his friend Wilbert Smith²⁹ told him the Roswell spacecraft had crossed through a "magnetic gate,"³⁰ affecting the propulsion system and bringing it down. Expanding this line of questioning, I noted several theories existed as to the precise location and date of the crash or any other reported crashes. Before the question was completed Colonel Corso held up three fingers at me. (Three crafts, Colonel?) One of the UFOs, he continued, was at the originally suspected Corona desert about 75 miles northwest of the major city of Roswell; a second vehicle came down about 150 miles west of the other location. The former, he said, crashed or exploded or both while the latter landed in an embankment mostly intact. This theory, I noted, had been supported by Stanton Friedman and Don Berliner in "Crash At Corona" :¹ but there was a third object in this scenario?

Corso then recalled his own UFO experience during his Nike Missile Battery days (sometime in 1958; the general time period is correct - RJV) Alone one day at his Command Post in Red Canyon, Corso was called by one of his staff who notified him "something strange" was going on at the debris field and he, Corso, might want to check it out. Corso understood this to mean an unidentified object

had been seen or spotted on radar so he grabbed some "company car keys", as he stated, and headed out to the location. (The "debris field" was the designated desert area, some miles away from the command post, wherein spent Nike missiles and the aircraft they'd targeted for surface to air missile testing would fall, usually in pieces, for a hasty identification, gathering and cleanup).

Arriving at the location alone, Corso saw what he'd expect to: desert, rocks and some brush. He says he waited for about ten minutes after which there appeared out of absolutely nowhere, and hovering just slightly above ground, a large flying saucer, with a small dome, silver grayish on top and with a flat black bottom. The officer drew closer, still inside his car that was now approximately 50-75 yards from the object when it suddenly disappeared without any upward movement. Corso said for a fleeting moment he'd wondered if the stifling desert heat had affected his senses or he'd hallucinated; he then figured if his "sighting" were real, it might reappear.

A waiting game resumed, this time for about a half an hour until he decided to give up and go back. Just then the saucer reappeared practically in the same location as before, briefly being visible and quickly making a repeat disappearance. Corso then moved some rocks and stones to within the sighting area, figuring physical evidence for this anomaly might exist if it returned. Remaining outside the vehicle, Corso waited a short time and then witnessed a third visual encounter with this object; however he now was in close proximity, so he quickly reentered his vehicle and began backing away from the scene. While doing so, he watched as the object again vanished. Returning nearer to the specific site area, he found that the rocks he'd moved into the hovering "spot" had all been crushed. Nothing further was said or clarified regarding this matter.

Our conversation then segued into the revelation of what the Colonel called "nuclear binding", a phrase I'd never heard before. Corso described nuclear binding, as best I can understand it, as a naturally occurring high spinning electromagnetic or nuclear "cylinder" (that I'll call similar to the spinning funnel of a tornado, only for purposes of discussion) through which anything passing within is literally reduced to "nothing" (or perhaps its original molecular or cellular building blocks?). This phenomenon, said the Colonel, is a totally unpredictable occurrence that scientists know can happen at most any time and often has; he further suggested that "nuclear binding" *might* (emphasis by author) explain some cases of disappearing ships, aircraft, etc. associated with the Bermuda Triangle. He added that, as far as he knew, scientists hadn't spoken openly about what he had just described.

I returned to another of my original letter questions to the Colonel, asking him to point me in the direction of someone or something to corroborate any portions of his story or the book. Corso's written response was that he had no permission to do so, by request in most cases. At the interview, I asked Corso to consider the same question from the "other" side, ie, had anyone active or retired in the military pressured you for in effect "breaking ranks" on Roswell? No, he replied, insisting "no one told me write the book or not write it, and no one said to talk or not to talk". The comment recalled his written remark that it would have bothered him more not to have told this story than to have done so. Confused by what seemed to be a nonchalant treatment of a most sensitive subject, I wondered aloud how this affected his security oath normally required for access to classified material. He responded that a three year rule is in effect for not revealing highly compartmentalized intelligence information after which program names, nicknames, codes, purposes, etc. change or become obsolete, in either case further prohibiting wider access any more than necessary.

(I wasn't quite satisfied with that answer but I let it ride. Later when the Colonel had departed Linda expressed her feeling that my "security" questioning may have insulted the Colonel. Having a brief Military Intelligence background myself, I disagreed. Besides, maybe the more effective way to create a "trail" would be to know someone who opposed these revelations being made public instead of those covertly supporting them.)

We expressed our curiosity if the Colonel's clandestine responsibilities or knowledge regarding UFO secrets had been overtly discussed with any other high echelon government officials. (Corso had mentioned former Attorney General Robert F. Kennedy in his book) The Colonel reiterated he had brought up the subject of UFOs with RFK around 1962 or at least early in the JFK Presidency, and that Robert had promised to discuss the matter with his brother in the future. The Colonel believed the Attorney General had in fact done so, thereby repeating a book claim, before John F. Kennedy was assassinated on November 22, 1963.

I distinctly remembered at that moment feeling very nervous about the subject matter being spoken openly among us. We weren't behind closed doors or any protected area at the time. This was a quiet restaurant with a low volume radio playing and a few scattered customers having breakfast along with a newspaper, but how did I know who may have been listening? I suggested to Linda we continue our meeting elsewhere, but she demurred and felt it would be unnecessary. I accepted her assurance and didn't feel compelled to reiterate my fear.

At 12:15 PM I motioned to Ms. Howe about keeping time, as we had separate return arrangements and we were more than an hour away from the airport of departure. We cordially brought the meeting to an end, collectively promising to keep the lines of communication open especially with the tentative videotaping project in mind. The Colonel put his left arm around Ms. Howe, looked at me and said "Always take care of this lady for me, will you?". I assured him that whenever Linda might need my help I would do my best to be there. We wished him well and Colonel Corso, very much a Lone Ranger of sorts, at least as I see it, rode off in a brand new 1998 Camaro that looked "spit shined". (I'd been aghast as I watched him drive up for the interview in that vehicle. The Colonel noticed my expression and laughed at me. "Yeah", he said, "my family thinks the ol' Colonel is a little crazy but at this point I'll do just what I want". His amusing quip had been the perfect tension breaker I needed to feel relaxed and comfortable in his presence.)

Returning to the airport in an unlikely torrential rain, Ms. Howe and I reviewed several interview points while sharing thoughts about the National Security Act Of 1947; I knew a little about the law, but Linda educated me as to just how many *volumes* the Act comprises. We also spoke of the military's "black budget" programs immune to any Congressional oversight¹, and a highly classified matter reportedly involving then-President Richard Nixon and the great entertainer Jackie Gleason.

All the while, I kept thinking how the U.S. Army had trained me as a Counterintelligence Agent, teaching me the Vietnamese language for a year prior to my setting foot in Asia, and then underutilizing me upon being assigned to Can Tho South Vietnam's 574th MI Detachment. Now, twenty seven years later, my investigative training, urges and instincts were coming back in a "rush". I had just joined a very special journalist and researcher in attempting to uncover what the U.S. Army -Air Force may have tried to hide, well outside the glare of public scrutiny, over a half century ago.

**A TELEPHONE INTERVIEW BY ROBERT J. VANDERCLOCK WITH FORMER
ROSWELL AREA MORTICIAN AND EMBALMER GLENN DENNIS, APRIL
6-7, 1998**

The disinformational confusion generated by the USAF "Crash Test Dummies" Report singularly prompted me to attempt to contact Glenn Dennis, current President of one of Roswell's two museums dedicated to the UFO phenomenon. During the Incident period, Dennis was employed at the nearby Ballard Funeral Home as a young mortician/embalmer, and I was hoping to learn a bit more of his experiences relating to the crash, stories which Glenn had undoubtedly told and retold more times than one could reasonably count.

In the research package I'd sent him in late March 1998, I included a letter voicing support for his apparent decision to protect the identity of the alleged "mystery nurse". She had informed Glenn that in 1947 she involuntarily assisted with the autopsies of alien crash victims at the Roswell Base Hospital. Mr. Dennis responded to my package just over a week after its dispatch, so we arranged to talk by phone on the following Monday, April 6, 1998. Since our initial conversation ended prematurely, we agreed to continue it on the next evening.

To begin, I thanked Glenn for responding and I reminded him I had praised his sense of loyalty with respect to concealing the nurse's identity. Unfortunately, I continued, since he'd offered a variety of names for the woman, each time leading investigators toward another dead end, Roswell believers and skeptics alike were now leaning toward treating the whole story as a fabrication. Some claimed either the nurse never existed or, as in the recent Air Force Report, they accepted a conventional explanation to reveal who she may have been. Glenn responded it didn't bother him that the Government was trying to change his story, saying "when you're in this business that's going to happen". He said he was "just a country undertaker, no more, no less," and while he didn't know the whole Roswell affair he did know well his own part of it and that it was the truth.

Eagerly anticipating his opinion of the 1994 "Roswell: The UFO Coverup" movie that starred Kyle MacLachlan, Dwight Yoakam and Martin Sheen, I wanted to find out what he thought of his own depiction. I was surprised at his thoughts on this matter; he hadn't seen much of the film but heard it was a government effort to debunk the first military officer at the crash scene, Major Jesse Marcel Sr. who, Glenn had heard, was "hallucinating" in the film. I countered by advising him to see the whole movie, even if he needed to borrow my copy, and doing so would help him assess it better. (I personally felt the film, though "Hollywoodized", was nevertheless an effective counterpoint to the debunkers of The Incident even if Roswell's original civilian investigator Stanton T. Friedman apparently had little or no input.)

In reviewing the tale of the "mystery nurse" Glenn described the woman as young, devoutly Catholic and, at the time, preparing to join a Catholic Order. On the night before Glenn's odd phone call from the "Roswell Base Mortuary Officer" the young General nurse, a Lieutenant, was at the Order's Home taking care of her personal matters before joining, and subsequently unaware of a General Order being issued, instructing all Roswell Hospital nurses *not to report to work the next morning*. (author emphasis) with no indication as to why such an Order had been given. Consequently when she did arrive for her next days' assignments she routinely began making her rounds, perhaps unaware that no other nurse may have been present.

About ninety minutes after the "Mortuary" call, Glenn drove out with the Funeral Home ambulance to retrieve an injured airman, as per Ballard's local contract, and brought him to the Roswell Base Hospital for treatment. Arriving inside, Glenn happened to look inside a parked military ambulance and witnessed some "fiberglass like" large pieces of something mostly colored blue and black, as he recalls. Dennis entered the Hospital door amidst a peculiar flurry of activity and he asked someone standing at the Coca Cola machine if there'd been some sort of accident. The person said they knew nothing at all. Moments later he saw his nurse friend exiting one of the rooms wearing a towel over her head and apparently gagging. Glenn asked her what was going on and she replied "Get out of here. You're in big trouble if you find out."

Just then two military policemen approached and began escorting the young mortician toward the exit door in what Glenn described as a firm yet gentle manner. One of the two MPs was verbally forceful over Dennis' presence; Glenn responded with a profanity, adding that "I'm a civilian and you can't talk to me like that". The hostile MP countered with "they'll be picking your bones out of the sand" if he didn't leave immediately. After the forced escort to his vehicle Dennis was followed by a military vehicle the full distance back to Ballard.

The next item of discussion was whether Mr. Dennis had ever heard of Norma Gardner whom I'd indicated in a previous paper, courtesy of a Jerome Clark book, had made a 1986 deathbed statement; she, in her capacity as a civilian employee of Wright Air Base, had seen some of the alien materials including the pathology reports of the alien victims. Glenn remembered my reference to her and said "that sounds a lot like Marion (or Marian) Bush", a name I was unfamiliar with. Dennis said he knew Bush and that she had died recently but had told him prior that she'd been involved in some way with the autopsy paperwork. Inquiring as to any potential next of kin for the deceased, I learned that Glenn knew of a few of her relatives but they were very hesitant to "talk about it". Perhaps, I replied, Glenn might give them my name if or when they might decide to share any recollections of Ms. Bush's experiences.

I mentioned to Mr. Dennis that it had taken a lot on my part to even attempt to contact him. I assumed that an uncountable number of researchers over the years had likely approached him, and probably bothered him to the point that he simply didn't want to hear it anymore. I had changed my feelings about contact sometime after viewing the Air Force Report of 6/25/97, quite outraged at what I'd witnessed on television. (A true advertiser going by the time honored reality of "it's not what they tell you, it's what they don't tell you". Air Force spokesperson Col. J. Haynes seemed almost embarrassed and somewhat frightened at the Press Conference, possibly anticipating the expected backlash from the media and the public. A poignant refutation of the whole USAF "show" appeared in a NY Daily News Editorial cartoon soon after; there stood Col. Haynes, unflappable in his magnificence before the assembled newsmen, photographers and the world's stage.....only, his head was that of a "grey" extraterrestrial, with the bottom caption reading, simply, "Case Closed." I told Mr. Friedman of this in a phone call, and it generated a good laugh from both of us.)

Mr. Dennis on the other hand seemed most cordial and appeared to appreciate the interest. He was aware the Air Force had set about trying to debunk his mystery nurse story by listing biographical information for the probable nurse or nurses being allegedly "protected". One such nurse was "Slatts" Wilson and I inquired about her. "Yeah I knew Slatts", Glenn said. "She was a big woman who was in charge of all the other nurses over there", but she was not connected to his special recollections of the period in question.

In the course of our discussions I told Glenn how privileged I'd been to meet Stan Friedman, Linda Moulton Howe, and Colonel Corso all in the space of about six months. Each of them indicated that the Roswell 50th Anniversary event during the previous July 4th had been very positive and encouraging. I had distanced myself from attending, fearing a "circus" atmosphere with normal media mocking or indifference, but hearing all the upbeat commentary had made me wish I'd been there. "When it comes to Roswell. Stan Friedmans' the man" Glenn said, and after I heartily agreed he added that he liked Friedman and Howe but asked what I thought of "that Corso fella". I said Linda and I liked his sense of humor and we viewed him as very honest, sensitive to his debunkers, and we were initially impressed with him. Glenn then stated he'd had a Two Star General friend of his (unnamed) check Corso out; the General came back and told Dennis he "couldn't find anything", an Officers' way of saying he checked out OK..

I also noted the Colonel had critiqued my papers by request, to which Glenn said that he too liked the papers, calling them "a pretty good job". I cautioned him that I was no scholar on The Incident; but Glenn repeated the remark and requested my permission to to make them a permanent addition to his Museum's Library. Quite surprised at this, I told him I wasn't sure either paper was anywhere "near" worthy of such an honor; I'd sent them only to verify my background as a serious Roswell enthusiast. Mr. Dennis persisted so I allowed for it, feeling very grateful for the consideration.

Repeating my appreciation at the end, I promised to get to Roswell sometime in my life and hopefully have a chance to visit him and others personally. "Well," said the self-styled country undertaker, "guys like Corso and I, we're getting up in years", intimating that sooner rather than later would be of benefit if I were to ever see him.. I concluded this very amiable experience by requesting that Glenn send me any available Museum paraphernalia, using the postage paid envelope I'd provided. He promised to comply and eight days later I received an informative package about the Museum, its short history and some of its more recent special guests.

NOTE: On June 18th and July 28th of 1998 I gave Roswell/UFO presentations to senior citizens at centers in East Rutherford and Garfield, respectively. These "electric" audiences made me feel most welcome and were collectively very receptive to my "open forum" approach to the subjects covered. Between the sessions, over one hundred and fifty five people attended.

When I returned home from the Garfield presentation, there was a phone message left by Glenn Dennis calling from Roswell New Mexico. He'd received my third paper and very kindly asked to add it to my other papers as a permanent part of the Museum Library. Glenn said he'd be out of town for the next ten days or so but wanted to call me prior to his departure.

I owe that nice man an appreciative thank you note.

EPILOGUE

In the early Spring of 1997, coinciding with the visually stupendous appearance of the Hale-Bopp Comet, nearly forty "Heaven's Gate" followers of the late cult leader Marshal Applewhite committed mass suicide.

The media was predictably agog with causes, analyses, hand wringing etc. for this most tragic event. Millions of people were subsequently told the group's alleged "signal" to leave their earthly "containers" toward some dubious new stage of fulfillment would be Hale-Bopp's appearance, "concealing a UFO behind it."

UFO enthusiasts were understandably unnerved, fearing the public would somehow associate an interest in the paranormal with such a maddening event or its perpetrators. However, UFOs had once again become a temporary hot button issue due to the tragedy. The Pentagon almost appeared ready and waiting to remind the American people that they'd long since closed the book on studying UFOs, adding that "they haven't investigated (them) since 1969³²".

The many thousands of UFO researchers, investigators and everyday "buffs" worldwide knew the Pentagon had committed a flat-out lie, especially by implying that noone else had seen any need to study UFOs either. Thankfully, someone did something about it. Professional UFO researchers held a "UFO Press Conference" on Monday April 7, 1997 at the Sky Garden of NYC's St. Moritz Hotel at precisely 12:00 noon. NY Center For UFO Studies (CUFOS) Director Michael Luckman opened the sparsely attended conference that included my friend Diane Stavaris and myself, but whose audience was comprised mostly of television or news media representatives..

The Pentagon statement was collectively refuted; Luckman displayed drawings of purported alien symbols as reported by the late Roswell crash witness Jesse Marcel Sr., noting the clear dissimilarity to the "flowers on tape" in the official Mogul Reports; a short NASA film alleging hostile UFO activity in space was shown and analyzed; television producer Sam Sherman discussed the "denial and ridicule" policy the Government and several of its agencies had adopted for fifty years in order to dull the public's perception of UFO reality; and Col. Kolman Von Kevitzsky (Ret.) spoke about the "Stargate Coalition". This group of retired military intelligence personnel and one ex-astronaut are seeking a security oath indemnification from President Clinton himself in order to reveal a variety of first-hand factual UFO information (I've learned their request was recently denied). Also, contributing "UFO Briefing Document" author J. Antonio Huneus reviewed information from the Rockefeller Foundation-financed publication.

I even added my own two cents; if UFOs didn't exist, I asked rhetorically, why are the Air Force regulations known as AFR 200-2 and JANAP 146 (respectively pertaining to the handling of serious UFO encounters; and defensive measures to counter any known or unknown hostile threat against the North American continent) still "in the books" as standard practice and have in fact been updated numerous times?



That's me (Mr. Photogenic - HA!) at right, with Col. Kolman Von Kevitzsky, now 89 years of age, at The UFO Press Conference at NY's St. Moritz Hotel, April 7, 1997.



Michael Luckman, Director of the NY Center for UFO Studies, chairing the UFO Press Conference. Also with Mr. Luckman (L to R); Television producer Sam Sherman, Col. Von Kevitsky, and UFO researcher and author J. Antonio Huneus, who provided me with the "UFO Briefing Document." (Photos by Diane Stavaris)

Liz Trotta, an attending Washington Times reporter, wrote a lengthy and very up-front article (reprinted in the Appendix) that was clearly fair and balanced its assessment of the Conference and varied Ufology subjects in general. Even better, the article was devoid of any "space cadet" references to those of us for whom UFOs are at least a serious concern. Her report would have been on the desk of each and every Senator and Congressperson in Washington D.C. on the morning of April 9, 1997, and therein lies a vindication of sorts. Between the 1995 "UFO Briefing Document" and the Washington Times, many important and new sets of eyes would now be opened up to an undeniable reality; all UFOs cannot immediately be dismissed outright as automatic hoaxes, misrepresentations, or honest mistakes.

For the media, however, something is "missing" here. I am to understand, as a political science maven, that one of several traditional media responsibilities in a democratic society is to be as liberally open minded as possible, and conscious of its "watchdog" role against unchecked government excess. When it comes to UFOs, the national media for the most part simply hasn't exercised that role.

Remember that the media is not wholly to blame in this instance. They've been burned before with UFO hucksters, "contactees" who in some cases have the most vivid imagination in order to solicit their fifteen minutes of fame. thousands of still photos of "flying saucers" often cleverly disguised as hubcaps, pieplates and double images, reports from people who "swear" the Cessna they saw was shaped like a double dinner plate, and more. Today in the Computer Tech Era, anyone already committed to a pro or anti-UFO opinion cannot even trust the most legitimate looking films of unknown objects.....but what about those individuals' stories and cases and cases not hoaxed?

Consider if you will several other factors. In the early 1950s the CIA embarked upon a UFO "Destabilization" program to undercut the passionate public interest in the subject by means of disinformation: a proposal to ask the Disney animators to add as many "little green men" in their cartoons as possible was even considered. This would assist in trivializing UFOs and make the matter a standing joke (two respected British UFO authors, Jenny Randles and Tim Good, independently reached that same conclusion). Many years later in 1997 the CIA tells us they "floated" a number of false UFO reports in the '60s and '70s to mask many of our sensitive spy plane flights (what?) Spy planes of that era or any era for that matter, flying in a linear direction and sounding like 10,000 cement mixers would be mistaken for UFOs only by someone who didn't "put enough water in it"! The CIA therefore reasons that supersecret spy craft would purposely fly low enough so everyone could spot them and think Orson Welles was right! (Silly me....I thought only the Air Force was practicing pretzel logic in the 1990s). Given their open admission, is the CIA now liable, under the nation's specific disinformation laws, *for having admitted they intentionally sought to deceive the public?* Who "polices" that one?

I feel that some of us who at least watch how our government and its agencies deal or don't deal with the UFO phenomenon would welcome increased media interest in the subject; or, as I used to think, should we just let the media continue to sleep and let professional Ufologists take care of one of their jobs for them? What if for example the State of New Jersey by virtue of a 100,000 vote referendum was required to petition the U.S. government and any affiliated government agency to immediately declassify any state-related Top Secret or higher UFO Documents? (Then, multiply by 50!) The thought came to me as a result of several readings of Stanton Friedman's short paper

titled "The Cosmic Watergate". It is a research work I consider required reading for anyone unwilling to believe that documentation supporting UFO reality exists.

Consider too the following, also from the same paper: as a result of a landmark 1983 Federal District Court decision under Judge Gerheart Gesell, the world learned that America's National Security Agency did in fact possess some 156 UFO documents of a Top Secret nature or higher. However, due to the ruling that "the public interest in disclosure is far outweighed by the sensitive nature of the materials and the obvious effect on national security their release might well entail," the Judge let stand the NSA's intent to suppress these documents from public scrutiny.

Judge Gesell never saw any of the actual documents as the NSA simply refused him the right to do so (democracy in action!) Instead, the NSA prepared a Top Secret twenty one page "in-camera" affidavit for the Judge (providing him with a special clearance in order to view the affidavit and nothing else) justifying the withholding of this sensitive material. Based only on what was revealed in a very compartmentalized document for his eyes only, Judge Gesell ruled in favor of nondisclosure. The Federal Court of Appeals agreed after also being shown the affidavit; then, The Supreme Court of the United States refused to hear the case, in effect agreeing with the Lower Court decision.

The argument had been made, and properly so, that disclosure of this highly classified material would compromise intelligence sources, data and data gathering methods protected by law. However the plaintiff, Citizens vs. UFO Secrecy (CAUS) had wanted solely the UFO information and would've accepted expurgated documents protecting the otherwise classified data. Still the NSA said no. Keep in mind also that the CIA began this bureaucratic boondoggle by responding to an FOIA request that it had no UFO information whatsoever, then was forced by court order to release some 900 pages of Secret-or-below documents. They also had twenty three of their most sensitive documents contained within the 156 never revealed by the NSA! Later an appeal by Stanton Friedman caused nine of the twenty three to be disclosed and these were mostly unclassified East European press abstracts about UFOs. A subsequent appeal for the remaining fourteen by Friedman resulted in a series of heavily blacked out pages, some completely so, being sent to the researcher.

Nothing to hide, say the debunkers? Not possible to maintain such a vast "conspiracy" amongst the many agencies with such a secret, says Philip Klass and others? Let the evidence stand.

Could the public attitude about UFOs be changing? Mr. Friedman has often indicated the likelihood of belief in UFOs increases with the greater degree of education, and as the official Roswell reports from the Air Force keep coming fast and furiously with all the subtlety of a three ring circus, perhaps the great majority of citizenry no longer tolerates being treated, as my sister Joy says, "like we just stepped off a potato truck"

I myself am beginning to sense these deliberately misleading official explanations for UFO encounters, after removing every other possible identification, may well be part of a protracted conditioning process.³³ If so it would work as follows; each new illogical pronouncement purposely stimulates mass discussion over what the "answer" truly represents.....or misrepresents. Such a practice wouldn't surprise me at all; the military officials who are or were specialists in deception and counterintelligence are the same people asking us to believe, from *their* vantage point, the unbelievable. Time is in this case not our enemy but a friend.

ADDENDUM 1

Linda Howe's newest work "Glimpses Vol.II etc." was one of the last books I digested before going full tilt on completing this research paper. I hadn't expected the book to divulge any new information pertinent to Roswell due to the wider and more eschatological scope of subjects covered, but I was delighted to have been incorrect.

One of Linda's listed sources told researcher Peter Bostrom in 1996 that, as a twenty year old Army soldier in 1959, he was assigned to Elmendorf Air Base in Alaska. This individual possessed a high security clearance for operating high frequency radio equipment while also doing security guard duty at Elmendorf, site of many U-2 spy plane takeoffs. The source, "Reed", says in 1960 or 1961 he was once assigned to nearby Ft. Richardson to assist in inventorying the contents of a large vault. Surrounded by bricked up windows and security doors, the vault contained huge amounts of classified military film³⁴, and the detail took several days. Within the facility was a viewing room for properly cleared personnel to review "sensitive" items, and within which was an even smaller vault room housing an estimated 2500 rolls.

During one of the days of this assignment, the captain in charge told the crew he'd be busy elsewhere for the rest of the day and just left, possibly unaware of the nature of the vault contents. Reed says the film canisters were identified on the outside only by numbers in most cases, but one larger can marked "Roswell" had several smaller containers inside. On one particular day the men completed their inventory work within two hours, leaving time for a soldier to grab the Roswell can and head for the viewing room. What they all saw, says Reed, were a number of short rolls of approximately fifteen minutes in length, 16mm, black and white, and silent³⁵. Depicted were a wreckage area, lines of debris with small and large metal type items scattered as a result of an obvious crash. Additionally visible was scorched ground and super thin material that some GIs were jumping on, attempting unsuccessfully to bend it³⁶.

Other rolls showed an area with a small circular disc buried halfway in an embankment, people near body bags, an estimated four small bodies and a six fingered hand sticking up from the ground, all some distance from the body bags.³⁷

The entire scene, the source continued, had several cameramen, armed personnel, trucks, jeeps and an ambulance, the way a typical military crash scene might look. The scarcity of visible vegetation made the source speculate its location was somewhere in the Southwest³⁸.

This story if true is remarkable on several levels. First, leave it to the military to store such supersensitive material about as far away from the public or media eye as could be imagined. In this instance the stored reels are housed in one of our northernmost installations far closer to the North Pole than, say, North Chicago. Second, hundreds or even thousands of men and women with flying experience and who might ever read this could well be saying to themselves "so that's where the film of my own UFO encounter ended up....no wonder our constant inquiries about it went unanswered!" (If that hypothetical quote seems implausible to the reader, be aware of Dr. Richard Haines, a retired NASA aerospace scientist. He has been compiling for years a dossier of serious

UFO encounters involving only private and commercial airplane pilots, jet pilots and astronauts, our most credible witnesses for such incidents. The number of cases in the dossier is now over *three thousand five hundred*). Third, some of our nation's most precious filmed secrets would have been handled quite routinely, something we all should be concerned about. Fourth, we may be able to make even less of the much-hyped and still unproven "Alien Autopsy" than before, what with descriptions of possibly two separate crash scenes as disclosed by Reed.

Finally, a parallel can be drawn from a comment by Stanton Friedman in his June 1997 lecture in Connecticut. Speaking about the human abduction syndrome, he estimates the number of persons worldwide who've claimed a serious UFO experience to be about fifteen million; however, he continues, "we need not worry about fifteen million. *We only need to worry about one.*"³⁹ In the same vein, should one and only one verified military film depict incontrovertible evidence of an extraterrestrial experience, then any other real or perceived ET event wouldn't matter for the moment. The extraterrestrial hypothesis will have been proven among all those cases that for one reason or other are unprovable, or hoaxed or disinformationally "leaked"⁴⁰.

My five years of studying the Roswell Incident has given me alternating bouts of euphoria, confusion, disaffection, elation, astonishment, humility and just about every emotion in between, not to mention a small hole in my pocket from time to time. It is the truth however that supercedes any private considerations, and I am driven by the desire to unmask that truth, no matter from whence it comes or what transpires from its revelation. As long as my instincts continue telling me I've locked onto something having far reaching and historic implications, I'll not rest without a definitive conclusion to the Roswell Incident. I believe devoutly that I will live to see it.

Correction: In the Appendix D Bergen Record newsarticle "Aliens Among Us?". I am incorrectly identified as "one of about 5,000 members of the Mutual UFO Network", a nationwide organization of sightings investigators who also disseminate UFO information, compile databases on the subject, etc. While I have colleagues in MUFON and the Center For UFO Studies (CUFOS), I have not been a member of either organization or any other group conducting UFO research.

ADDENDUM 2

My friend Linda Moulton Howe called me on Friday, July 17, 1998 at about 7:00 PM. She'd received a fax from radio talk show host Art Bell ("Dreamland") informing her our mutual acquaintance Colonel Philip J. Corso had passed away that day.

Apparently the Colonel had never quite recovered from complications due to a massive heart attack on June 9, 1998, although he seemed to be responding well, and lately his condition had been upgraded from intensive care to serious to stable.

Our phone conversation would've indicated to any third party just how empty we both felt with the death of Philip Corso. We hadn't been able to reach the Colonel via any form of communication since the end of March 1998. At that time I received his short letter, followed soon after by some brief information he'd asked me to pass on to Linda. Otherwise, I was unable to send a get-well card through to him or even his copy of "Roswell: Toward Final Revelations".

I repeated the news of the Colonel's death to a few "network" friends and Stanton Friedman, telling them all I had sensed some real "fight" in this man, and that Linda and I felt he was being truthful with his book allegations which had stunned readers nationwide.

Mr. Friedman concurred with us that so much of the Corso story was still unresolved, and that fact is unfortunate along with his passing. The Colonel was working on the rudiments of a second book, that much we knew: whether it will be finalized and released posthumously, and by whom, is unknown at this time.

For me, the opportunity of meeting this remarkable gentleman and examining what he had to say, and undertaking this project with someone of such eminent stature as Linda Moulton Howe, was a most exciting moment in my life. The feeling here, though, is one of having consumed half of the greatest tasting sandwich, moments before the remainder inadvertently falls down a manhole cover, lost forever.

Despite whatever questions the book failed to answer, I felt Colonel Corso was an American hero for revealing an ultimate truth as he believed it to be and I'm relieved I told him so, more than once, while I had the chance. I can hope an acquaintance or one of his peers takes up where he left off regarding Roswell and the so-called "UFO Working Group"; regardless, I will miss him dearly and be forever grateful he cared enough to respond to me, all because I took a chance on writing him.

APPENDIX A

(ADDRESS AND SOME TEXT PORTIONS EXPURGATED)

961017

Jesse Marcel Jr.

Mr. Robert J Vanderlook
264 Wales Avenue
Riveredge, N.J. 07661-1520

Dear Bob,

Congratulation on the new additions to your family there is nothing that
sements the bond of a man and his wife more than young children. My
wife and I have a total of eight kids which can be quite taxing to our
sanity, but I would not have it any other way.

Please excuse the tardiness in answering your letter, but your
correspondence was misplaced and it just surfaced the light of day most
recently.

I read the abbreviated Air Force Report with interest and was really amused with the conclusions. It is obvious that the Air Force has its own agenda and the Mogel Balloon conclusion is a smoke screen of the highest order. They (Capt. Andrew) in the declassification team have gotten quite nasty in their handling of witnesses namely me and my father. I have it on good authority (Stan Friedman) that they were working with a hatchet man in the form of Robert Todd who has written the most despicable articles about me and my dad. In one letter I saw he said that the Big Sky State of Montana should be renamed the 'big lie' state since I live here. In another letter he was very derisive of me because I ride a motorcycle for transportation and called me an "effeminate punk." At any rate McAndrew was working with Todd and I am sure provided the necessary information for his insults.

No, the debris I saw in Roswell was not that of a 'mogel balloon' and when I refused to go along with McAndrew and the Air Force Report, (I had several phone conversations with the good Capt) all hell broke loose. Your tax dollars in action, ha!

The reality of an extraterrestrial event at Roswell will sooner or later be officially sanctioned but not at this time. I have been told that this will not happen until the powers to be determine it is in the public's interest.

NASA has and maybe still is conducting a study on the "Societal Impact" of the release of the reality of extraterrestrial visits. If it is determined, the impact will not be negative, then maybe we can look forward to the announcement being made in our lifetimes.

I for one already know the reality of these 'visits' and this knowledge has

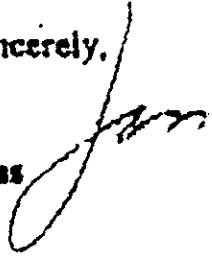
not destroyed me.

I could launch into a very philosophical discussion; on what this knowledge has meant for me but would not want to bore you with my personal feelings.

Feel free to write at any time.

Sincerely,

Joas



The Washington Times

WASHINGTON, D.C., WEDNESDAY, APRIL 9, 1997 4a

UFO devotees congregate, warn about alien presence

Is U.S. government 'programming us for contact?'

By Liz Trotta
THE WASHINGTON TIMES

NEW YORK — UFO watchers — wary of any association with the Heaven's Gate cult but furious at the Pentagon for denying any knowledge of extraterrestrial sightings and landings — gathered here to decry what they describe as the "world's largest cover-up."

In fact, said Michael Luckman, director of the New York Center for UFO Research, the U.S. government, far from ending its investigation of extraterrestrial probes, could be preparing the public for an encounter with aliens from outer space.

"They may be programming us for contact," Mr. Luckman asserted Monday at a news conference chaired by several UFO experts in the Sky Garden at the St. Moritz Hotel. It is not inconceivable, he added, that these aliens with whom earth is destined to meet are "little beings already here on reconnaissance."

UFO watchers here sprang into action after a Pentagon briefer's statement last week that the Air Force no longer investigates sightings of possible alien aircraft. From 1947 to 1969, "Project Blue Book," with headquarters at Wright-Patterson Air Force Base in Dayton, Ohio, looked into 12,618 sightings, deciding that most of them were the result of weather or nearby aircraft. There were 701 unidentified sightings.

Distancing himself from the Rancho Santa Fe mass suicide by members of the West Coast cult, Mr. Luckman said: "This is no Heaven's Gate. This is Alien Gate."

"This has been a difficult time for us involved in serious UFO research, but now that initial shock has worn off we feel compelled to

Michael Luckman talks of "a worldwide UFO cover-up" involving former astronauts and Egyptian hieroglyphics.

answer statements made by the Pentagon denying the existence of UFOs and denying that the government is hiding alien bodies."

Responding to the UFO group's charge that the Pentagon is covering up its findings while continuing to investigate such paranormal phenomena, spokesman Col. Dick Bridges said, "There were no extraterrestrial vehicles, no evidence of extraterrestrial beings or spacecraft, nothing that would be a threat to our national security." But some of the sightings, he said, could not be explained.

Mr. Luckman referred to "a worldwide UFO cover-up" that includes hidden crash saucers, secreted extraterrestrial bodies, former astronauts, cylindrical metal objects seen from the Apollo 16 mission, and Egyptian hieroglyphics employed as an alien language. Contact with aliens is, in his view, not only possible but imminent.

One way the government is preparing Earth for contact with these beings is by conducting probes on Mars, he said. One probe is scheduled to deploy a robot on July 4.

Billed as the "smoking gun," Mr. Luckman showed a videotape of an official NASA space shuttle mis-

sion on Sept. 15, 1991. In it, Mr. Luckman said, "star wars" missiles, indicated by white streaks, are trying to shoot down spacecrafts, indicated by white dots.

NASA spokesman Brian Welch in Washington said the film shown at the news conference was taken routinely by a low-light-level camera attached to the shuttle that was aimed at the Earth and operated by a ground controller. The camera shows ice crystals in orbit with the shuttle. They are being blown around by steering rockets, or thrusters, used to steer and stabilize the spacecraft.

"If you were looking at this tape and had fanciful imagination, you could convince yourself you were seeing an object coming at you. NASA does not investigate UFOs," Mr. Welch said.

But Mr. Luckman was adamant in his certainty about recent sightings. Just two weeks ago, he said, 10,000 people in Phoenix witnessed a "fleet" of brightly-lit UFOs flying over that city, and residents of Pine Bush, N.Y.; Gulf Breeze, Fla.; and Mexico City have frequently encountered such craft.

Jose Antonio Huneus, a Chilean journalist and UFO researcher, discussed his findings on recent extraterrestrial sightings and landings. The study, "UFO Briefing Document — The Best Available Evidence," was commissioned by philanthropist and UFO enthusiast Laurance S. Rockefeller.

Mr. Rockefeller circulated the briefing paper to world movers and shakers such as former Secretary of State Henry A. Kissinger. Mr. Rockefeller reportedly also tried to influence President Clinton to make public the government's UFO files, but to no avail.

SHEILA WIDNALL
SECRETARY, U.S. AIR FORCE
(IN CARE OF) W. CLINTON
PRESIDENT OF THE UNITED STATES
1600 PENNSYLVANIA AVENUE
WASHINGTON DC 20005

DEAR MADAME SECRETARY,

AS A ROSWELL RESEARCHER WHO HAPPENED TO BE HOME FOR LUNCH JUST WHEN THE "LIVE" AIR FORCE PRESS CONFERENCE ON ROSWELL WAS STARTING ITS BROADCAST, I WASN'T SURE IF A SENSE OF RELIEF, SADNESS, OUTRAGE, OR DISAFFECTION WOULD HAVE BEEN THE PROPER RESPONSE TO ITS RESULT. I FOUND MYSELF ASSESSING THE SIGNIFICANCE OF THE "ROSWELL REPORT" 1997 EDITION AS INDICATED BY COL. HAYNES FROM SEVERAL DIFFERENT DIRECTIONS:

1. THE CONCLUSIONS COULD HAVE REPRESENTED A LAST FRANTIC GASP FROM THE USAF'S REMAINING BAND OF POST WAR WARRIORS WHO, HAVING HAD ROSWELL KNOWLEDGE FROM THE BEGINNING, ARE SO "IN DEEP" ON THE SECRET THAT THEY'RE ADMITTING THEY DON'T KNOW HOW TO GET OUT OF IT.
2. THE CONCLUSIONS MAY HAVE BEEN PART OF A CONTINUING ATTEMPT TO INSULATE CIVILIZATION FROM A HITHERTO-UNSTATED SECRET. COURTESY OF COL. PHILIP CORSO'S BOOK "THE DAY AFTER ROSWELL" WHOSE ALLEGATIONS, IF TRUE, CERTAINLY RAISE THE STAKES ON WHAT HAPPENED IN THE CORONA DESERT IN EARLY JULY 1947.
3. THE CONCLUSIONS MAY HAVE BEEN INTENTIONALLY ILLOGICAL ANSWERS DESIGNED TO STIMULATE WORLDWIDE DEBATE ON THE MATTER, AN EFFECT THAT FITS IN QUITE NICELY WITH A "CONDITIONING" PROCESS.
4. THE CONCLUSIONS WERE BELIEVED TO BE TRUE.

HOW ABOUT A CLOSER LOOK AT ITEM 4?

I REMEMBER JOSEPH KITTINGER'S RECORD PARACHUTE DIVE AS A TEENAGER, AN EVENT THAT MADE ME AND MILLIONS OF OTHERS BURST WITH PRIDE IN AMERICA. I ASSUMED EVEN THEN THAT TEST BODIES OR "DUMMIES" WOULD HAVE BEEN USED IN PREPARATION FOR THE ACTUAL JUMP. WHERE HOWEVER IS THE SUBSTANTIVE PROOF THAT THESE TESTS WOULD HAVE STARTED IN 1947, BARELY BEYOND CHUCK YEAGER'S BREAKING OF THE SOUND BARRIER, OR THAT ROSWELL WITNESSES WOULD SOMEHOW HAPPEN TO LOSE SIX FULL YEARS OF MEMORIES, OR THAT A LIVING BREATHING ANYTHING WOULD BE MISTAKEN FOR A CRASH TEST DUMMY WHOSE APPEARANCE BY YOUR OWN RECORDS FIRST BEGAN IN 1953? EVEN COL. KITTINGER'S OWN STATEMENT TO THE EFFECT THAT "I'M GLAD THIS IS FINALLY PUT TO REST" SOUNDS HOLLOW WITHIN THE ABOVE CONTEXT.

THE BEST AVAILABLE EVIDENCE INDICATES THAT WHATEVER CRASHED AT THE CORONA DESERT OUTSIDE ROSWELL DURING THE PERIOD IN QUESTION EITHER EXPLODED AND CRASHED, OR VICE VERSA AND SCATTERED WRECKAGE FOR THOUSANDS OF FEET AROUND WITHIN WHAT MAY BE A PRIMARY AND SECONDARY SITE.....SO WHAT RELEVANCE. EXACTLY DOES THE SAUCERLIKE CONTRAPTION IN COL. HAYNES' FILE FILM" HAVE IN THIS MATTER?

THE FIRST AND SECOND "FINAL OFFICIAL WORD" OF THE USAF IN THEIR 1994 AND 1995 VERSIONS OF THIS INCIDENT STATE QUITE CLEARLY IN ONE SECTION (THOUGH QUITE AMBIGUOUSLY IN ALL OTHER SECTIONS) THAT THE REASON THERE WAS HARDLY ANY MENTION OF "ALIEN BODY RETRIEVAL" WAS THAT (QUOTE)"FIRST, THE RECOVERED WRECKAGE WAS FROM A MOGUL BALLOON". I WONDER IF THE SIGNER OF THIS REPORT, COL. RICHARD WEAVER AND HIS COLLEAGUE, CPT. JAMES MCANDREW MIGHT NOW BE LIABLE UNDER THE NATION'S LAWS REGARDING DISINFORMATION. IF YOU ARE HOLDING FAST TO THE TEST DUMMY THEORY?

THE PROJECT MOGUL EXPLANATION CONTINUES TO RAISE FAR MORE QUESTIONS THAN ANSWERS. IT WAS NO GREAT SECRET TO PROFESSIONAL UFO INVESTIGATORS, I'M TOLD, THAT MOGUL WAS A CLASSIFIED PROGRAM WITH TOTALLY UNCLASSIFIED PARTS. THE SUM OF WHICH NEVER WORKED ANYWAY. WHAT APPARENTLY SURPRISED THE INVESTIGATORS FAR MORE WAS DELIBERATE ATTEMPTS IN BOTH 1992 AS WELL AS THE 1994 MOGUL REPORT TO LINK MOGUL TO ROSWELL, THE LATTER USAF INVESTIGATION SEEMING TO BE FOR ALL INTENT AND PURPOSE "CONTROLLED". STANTON FRIEDMAN, ROSWELL'S ORIGINAL INVESTIGATOR WITH WHOM I RECENTLY SPENT SEVEN HOURS, HAD EARLIER INFORMED ME VIA CORRESPONDENCE, DATED 4/16/95,

"IT IS NOT TRUE THAT THAT THE USAF HAS RELEASED EVERYONE FROM THEIR SECURITY OATHS (IE. TO SPEAK OPENLY ABOUT ROSWELL WITHOUT FEAR OF JAIL FINE, OR FULL LOSS OF MILITARY BENEFITS). EVEN THE THREE RETIRED GUYS THEY TALKED TO (NEWTON, CAVITT, ETC.) WERE RELEASED ONLY TO TALK TO THE (USAF) INVESTIGATORS. I HAVE BEEN ASKING FOR A BLANKET RELEASE FOR YEARS...."

THE RECENT AIR FORCE ATTEMPTS TO ASSURE THE PUBLIC THERE IS NO CONTINUING "COVER UP" HAS BEEN MET WITH A NEAR FIRESTORM OF RIDICULE. NOT NECESSARILY FROM THE NOTION BUT FROM WHAT "PROOF" HAS SUPPORTED THAT ASSERTION! AS SUCH, YOU COULD CONCEIVABLY RAISE THE AIR FORCE CREDIBILITY LEVEL ON THIS ISSUE A THOUSAND FOLD BY ANNOUNCING A FULL GENERAL BLANKET INDEMNIFICATION FOR ANYONE, ACTIVE OR RETIRED, AMONG AIRFORCE PERSONNEL WHO HAVE DIRECT OR CONTRIBUTORY ROSWELL KNOWLEDGE.....AND SUGGEST THE SECRETARIES OF ALL MILITARY BRANCHES- DO THE SAME. YOU COULD URGE ANY CIVILIAN AGENCY OF THE US GOVERNMENT TO ALSO COMPLY, AND SUPPORT THE RELEASE OF ANY HITHERTO "MISSING OR MISFILED" DOCUMENTATION TO ASSIST THE EFFORT. YOU COULD LEND COPIES OF YOUR STATEMENT TO THE MEDIA AND ANY CIVILIAN GROUPS WHO'D NORMALLY BE INTERESTED IN SUCH A THING. WITH A PERSONAL

ASSURANCE THAT ANYONE WITH RELEVANT INFORMATION HAS YOUR, AND THE PRESIDENT'S FULL PROTECTION AGAINST ANY PRESSURE OR INTIMIDATION TO SPEAK OUT. SINCE COL. HAYNES HAS ALREADY STATED "CASE CLOSED", SUCH AN AFTER THE FACT ANNOUNCEMENT SHOULDN'T BE A PROBLEM IF THERE'S NOTHING ADDITIONAL TO REVEAL. IN FAIRNESS, THIS STEP MIGHT VERY WELL LEND FURTHER CONFIRMATION TO THE THEORIES ALREADY ESPOUSED BY THOSE UNDER YOUR COMMAND. HOWEVER YOU OWE IT TO YOURSELF A FAR BETTER OPPORTUNITY TO SUBSTANTIATE THE FINDINGS ANNOUNCED.

PRIOR TO THE PRESS CONFERENCE, THE NEW REPORT WAS QUITE COINCIDENTALLY LEAKED, SEVERAL DAYS EARLY, TO A KNOWN UFO SKEPTIC WHO HAS BEEN ACCUSED BY A RESPECTED UFO AUTHOR OF BEING A "CIA ASSET". THAT ACTION, ALONG WITH PERSISTENT RUMORS THAT MANY CURRENT CIVILIANS AND MILITARY PEOPLE IN THE US GOVERNMENT, WITH TOP SECRET SECURITY CLEARANCES OR HIGHER, ARE IN ON "THE SECRET" SHOULD PROVIDE ADDITIONAL ACTION ON YOUR PART, AS WELL AS OTHER HIGH GOVERNMENT OFFICIALS. FOR A FULLY FACTUAL, UNEXPURGATED AND HONEST ACCOUNTING OF THIS INCIDENT, SOMETHING THAT MANY MILLIONS OF PEOPLE WORLDWIDE STILL BELIEVE HAS NOT OCCURRED.

I WILL BE PROVIDING COPIES OF THIS CORRESPONDENCE TO OTHER PARTIES AND I THANK YOU IN ADVANCE FOR A TIMELY RESPONSE TO THIS LETTER.

ROBERT J. VANDERCLOCK
RIVEREDGE, NJ 07661

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21. U. S. GENERAL ACCOUNTING OFFICE REPORT TO THE HON. STEVEN SCHIFF, HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES, GOVERNMENT RECORDS RESULTS OF A SEARCH FOR RECORDS CONCERNING THE 1947 CRASH NEAR ROSWELL NEW MEXICO. July 1995, US General Accounting Office, Box 6015, Gaithersburg, Md. 20884-6015.

Cover transparency prepared by Helene VanDerClock.

NOTES AND REFERENCES

1. Roswell Report, Fact vs. Fiction In The New Mexico Desert, p.125.
2. The Air Force Report On Roswell, Sept. 8,1994, reprinted in Skeptical Inquirer Magazine,p.46.
3. The conversation pertained to the famous (police officer Lonnie)"Zamora" sighting at Socorro, NM during the late afternoon of April 24,1964 and a reported planned landing at nearby Alamo-gordo AB some twelve hours later, April 25,1964. Mr. Friedman and I speculated on the possibility of a connection between the two encounters. "Alien Agenda" author Jim Marrs recently indicated that the strange symbols Zamora recalled seeing on the side of his witnessed object, symbols he was able to recreate perfectly from memory, represent the Arabic astrological sign for the planet Venus.
4. Don Berliner and Stanton T. Friedman. Crash At Corona, 50th Anniversary Edition, p.115.
5. Mr. Friedman noted in "The Roswell Incident, The USAF and The NY Times" that with Project Mogul known to UFO researchers for some years, The Air Force was guilty of a "pre-emptive strike" in attempting to usurp the supposed partner in the records search, The GAO. What was in effect an Air Force Press Release, one that was not seriously questioned or analyzed by writer William C. Broad, appeared on p.1 of the Sept. 16,1994 edition of the Times.
6. GAO Results of a Search for Records, etc., June 28,1995, p.4.
7. The Roswell Report, Case Closed, June 25,1997, pgs. 25-27.
8. Ibid. p. 89.
9. William Moore, Crashed Saucers, Evidence In Search Of Proof, p. 167.
10. Ibid.
11. Ibid. p.168.
12. Kevin D. Randle, The Randle Report, UFOs In The 90s, p. 200.
13. Ibid. p. 201.
14. Ibid. p. 203.
15. Stanton T. Friedman, Top Secret/Majic, p. 113.
16. Stanton T. Friedman, in personal correspondence to the author, reprinted in "The Roswell Incident, The Rush Toward Full Accounting". April 15,1995.

17. Dr. Jesse Marcel Jr., in personal correspondence to the author. Appendix A (expurgated.)
18. The Air Force Report On Roswell, op. cit., p. 48.
19. Personal correspondence, Footnote 16, op. cit.
20. A personal fax letter to the author, April 28, 1998.
21. Whitley Strieber, Majestic, p. 315.
22. Stanton T. Friedman, in phone conversation with the author, approx. three weeks following his 6:21/97 lecture in Cheshire, Ct.
23. Philip J. Klass, The Real Roswell Crashed Saucer Coverup, p. 212.
24. Timothy Good, Beyond Top Secret, p. 540.
25. Philip J. Corso with William Birnes, The Day After Roswell, pgs. 3-4.
26. Ibid.
27. Linda Moulton Howe, Glimpses Of Other Realities Volume II: High Strangeness, p. 33.
28. Col. Corso was emphatic the UFO simulated on p. 33 of the Linda Howe book, although representing a 1948 Farmington NM encounter, resembled clearly the UFO he'd seen years later.
29. Wilbert Smith, a high ranking Canadian engineer had a Top Secret clearance and access to the highest levels of the US Government. Smith first headed Project Magnet, Canada's initial investigation of the UFO phenomenon. The now famous "Smith Memo", classified Top Secret in 1950 and revealed years later, stated in part that as the result of (Smith's) discreet inquiries via the Canadian Embassy in Washington, he learned that the (UFO) matter is "the most highly classified secret in U.S. History, rating higher than the H-Bomb". Smith died in 1962.
30. Philip J. Corso, in his initial letter to the author, September 1, 1997.
31. Timothy Weiner, Blank Check, p. 5.
32. A 10/20/69 memo from General Carroll Bolender indicated that, in paraphrase, national security-related UFO incidents are handled through Air Force Manual 55-11 and JANAP 146 "and are not part of the BlueBook system". The memo is further clarified in "Important Quotes About UFOs From Government Documents" by Stanton T. Friedman, c 1991.
33. Ref. my letter to President Clinton, Appendix C.
34. Linda Moulton Howe, "Glimpses Vol II etc" p. 42..
35. Ibid. p. 43.

36. Ibid.
37. Ibid. p. 44.
38. Ibid.
39. Ibid. p. 47.
40. Gerald K. Haines. The CIA's Role In The Study Of UFOs. 1947-1990.
41. In his book, during our December 4, 1997 interview and in my phone talks with him, Colonel Corso said over the years he'd heard the so-called supersecret high level organization, entrusted by President Truman with controlling all access to UFO information, called by several different names. However he *never* (author emphasis) said he knew of them as "Majestic-12", "MJ-12" or anything remotely similar. He also said he himself was once accused by someone of being a member of the group, a charge he categorically denied.

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